

The Song of the Engine

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perseverance

Warm-up

Talk about your experiences of travelling in a train. What different sounds and sights did you see and hear during such a journey?



COM



When you travel on a railway,
And the line goes up a hill,
Just listen to the engine
As it pulls you with a will.
Though it goes so very slowly
It sings this little song,
"I think I can, I think I can,"
And so it goes along.

But later on the journey
When you're going down a hill,
The train requires no pulling,
And the engine's singing still.
If you listen very quietly
You will hear this little song,
"I thought I could, I thought I could,"
And so it speeds along.

line

(here) railway tracks for trains to run on

journey

a long trip

requires

needs

will

(here) a strong wish to do something

speeds

moves very fast



Understanding the Poem

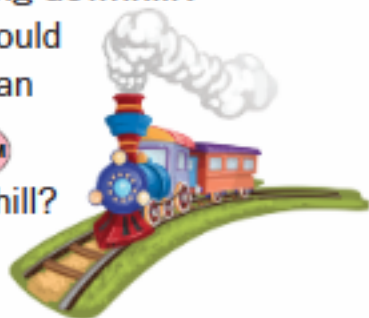
(reading for main ideas)

A. Tick (✓) the right options to answer these questions.

- What is the song the engine sings while going uphill?
 - I think I can
 - I thought I could
 - I think I could
 - I thought I can
- What is the song the engine sings while going downhill?
 - I think I can
 - I thought I could
 - I think I could
 - I thought I can

B. Work in pairs and answer these questions.

- What is the speed of the train when it goes uphill?
- When does the train require no pulling?
- Why do you need to listen very quietly?



C. State whether the sentences are true (T) or false (F).

Work in pairs and check each other's answers. 

- At the beginning of the poem, the train is moving up a hill. _____
- The engine struggles to climb and so it is moving fast. _____
- The engine sings 'I think I can' because the journey is not easy. _____
- The engine has to pull the train while going downhill. _____
- The song is now 'I thought I could' which shows the engine has climbed over the hill. _____

D. Think and answer.

(reading for inference; HOTS)

- Explain the difference in meaning between the two songs of the engine.
- Is the engine happy or sad as it pulls the train along? Give reasons for your answer.

E. Discuss in class. self-motivation

(value-based question)

Do you sing or hum a tune while doing a difficult task? How do you lift your spirits on a dull day when not much is happening? Does a song or chant help in such situations? Give examples to support your answer.



Appreciation

Read these lines aloud.

- I think I can, I think I can.
- I thought I could, I thought I could.

The rhythm and repetition of the words sound as though a train is chugging along. Say these at different speeds and you will enjoy the poem even more. 



Life Skills Activity

(self-awareness)

Write your name on a sheet of paper with the letters arranged one below the other. For each letter, think of a word or group of words that describe you. Look at the example below. Decorate the paper with photographs or drawings that make you happy.  



A chiever
D ancer
I ntelligent
L ovable



Put up this chart where you can see it often.

